

Another Adorno-against-Wittgenstein moment

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "Another Adorno-against-Wittgenstein moment", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, June 12, 2012, <https://doi.org/10.59348/pex2h-1zd33>.

Just found one that I hadn't noticed before:

The term "commitment" unites Heidegger and Jaspers together with the lowest tractatus-writers.

– Adorno, Theodor W., *The Jargon of Authenticity*, trans. by Knut Tarnowski and Frederic Will (London: Routledge & Kegan Paul, 1986), p. 69.

This is a strange conflation if it is indeed supposed to refer to Wittgenstein's *Tractatus*, at which Adorno takes aim in several other places. (Adorno, Theodor W., *Against Epistemology: A Metacritique*, trans. by Willis Domingo (Oxford: Blackwell, 1982), p. 62.; Adorno, Theodor W., 'Skoteinos, or How to Read Hegel', in *Hegel: Three Studies*, trans. by Shierry Weber Nicholsen (Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press, 1993), pp. 89–148, p. 101.) Here, he seems to bring existentialism in line with Wittgenstein's logical positivism. Although Wittgenstein's book is named, on Moore's suggestion, after Spinoza's *Tractatus Theologico-Politicus* and it, obviously, just means "tract", I suspect that Adorno uses the term in order to have another pop at Wittgenstein, but in a strange place.

Featured image by [Cuito Cuanavale](#) under a CC-BY license.